When the last question had been answered, I returned to our dressing room and Russell and I both addressed the players, thanking them all for their efforts and telling them we could be proud of our performance. We drank a few beers, tried to cheer each other up and went through to the home dressing room to spend some time with the New Zealanders, and to wish them well in the final against the Australians.

There is no doubt that our failure to win the 2015 Cricket World Cup ranks as the greatest disappointment of my cricket career. I genuinely believed we were strong enough. I genuinely believed it was our time. I genuinely believed that, if we had got past New Zealand in the semifinal, we had the ideal combinations of batsmen and spin bowlers to take on Australia at the Melbourne Cricket Ground and potentially win the final. I believed all that, but it didn't happen. It was not, in fact, our destiny.

Let's get some things straight.

We did not lose the semifinal because of the decision to replace Kyle with Vernon. I won't deny the saga was unsettling on the evening before the match but, in the event, Vernon bowled eight overs, bowled well and conceded only 52 runs; his economy rate of 6.50 was only bettered by Imran.

We did not lose the semifinal because of the rain interruption. I won't deny it was frustrating, because we were taking control at the time, but it cannot be cited as a reason for defeat.

We did not lose the semifinal because our strategy was wrong; in almost all respects, in our batting plans, in our bowling changes and in our field placings, we got almost everything right.

So what did go wrong?

In my view, we lost the semifinal because we failed to take five clear opportunities. We put the opposition under pressure, and the pressure created the opportunities, but, through no lack of effort and no lack of desire, as individuals and as a team, we were unable to make the play